



Review
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"Artifex Verborum" is the companion program to "Translat." The goal here is to parse correctly the forms of every Latin word in a sentence. A student's knowledge is reinforced by the use of various screens or menus to categorize each word. The program analyzes an incorrect answer and shows the student the proper context and prompts a correct entry. When the sentence is fully parsed, the screen adds an English translation to signal success.

Culley's achievement is not merely to produce five excellent programs but to customize them to specific texts. In this way, the software does not distract from the teacher's lessons but repeats and reinforces them. The software is attractive and totally functional. While good software is never inexpensive, volume discounts are available as is a sample disk ($15.00). If you are a well-intended Latin teacher, learning BASIC or Pascal programming to help you teach Latin, put aside the noble drudgery of reinventing the wheel; a high-performance radial exists and is called "Latin Skills."

Duquesne University LAWRENCE E. GAICHAS
CW 79.5 (1986)

A. M. Devine and L. D. Stephens. *Language and Metre: Resolution, Porson's Bridge, and Their Prosodic Basis*. American Classical Studies 12. Chico, CA: Scholars Press, 1984. Pp. xii, 147. $11.25 (pb.).

This is a "difficult read" permeated with statistical argumentation, addressed primarily to hard-core metricians. Although the authors might sometimes have been kinder to statistically uninitiated readers, this is an important study, well worth the second or third read-through it may require.

Chapter 1, "Porson's Bridge", surveys some twenty-two bridge rules in trimeter, tetrameter, dactylo-epitrite, hexameter and paroemiac verse, and then examines three major explanatory theories of bridge phenomena, involving metrical boundaries, duration, or stress. After differentiating between rhythmic versus prosodic components in bridge rules, the authors demonstrate the inadequacy of these three theories for explaining the complex of rhythmic and prosodic patterning they describe.

Despite its statistical orientation, Chapter 2, "Resolution", is more accessible to the general classicist, since resolution is a more familiar metrical feature than bridges, and since the chapter contains intriguing developmental accounts of the tragedians' trimeter practice. After introducing two major resolution theories ("durational" and "stress"—cf. the bridge theories listed above), the authors study the development of seven major word shapes as used in resolution in the trimeter. The chapter concludes with the provocative discussion of the distinction between purely metrical factors affecting resolution, versus the poet's compositional strategies.

In Chapter 3, "A Theory of Bridges", the authors show that the metrical constraints they describe require a theory of suprasyllabic prosody both at the word level and the phrase level. They then sketch such a theory (providing an attendant formalism), and discuss its application to the data. The monograph concludes with a penetrating overview of certain phonostylistic issues central both to metrical theory and stylistic analysis generally. Apart from these concluding remarks, this is an unsatisfying chapter: given developments in suprasegmental phonology since about 1974, the argumentation lacks the scope and rigor necessary to justify the authors' particular theory, which is largely derivative of work

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by Liberman and Prince published in 1977. (The cross-linguistic arguments, from Chinese, Lithuanian et al., may impress some classicists; but linguists will be annoyed at these superficial treatments.) The 136-item bibliography stops at 1981; indices are lacking.

Diachronic metrics (nowhere mentioned by the authors) should gain substantially from the results of this study. While the book's thrust is avowedly synchronic, certain diachronic theories depend crucially on bridge phenomena: witness Nagy's treatment of Hermann's bridge in his theory of the origin of the hexameter. One may also wonder how anaclasis—which is poorly understood, especially in diachronic terms—operates within the authors' framework. These are not so much quibbles about omissions as indications of the stimulating effect this book should have on future research in metrics.

Phillips Academy BRENT VINE
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Barry Baldwin (tr.). *Timarion*. Detroit: Wayne State University Press, 1984. Pp. 161. $18.95.

This is a valuable and welcome addition to the successful Byzantine Texts in Translation initiated by Harry Magoulias. Its strength lies in the fact that it disproves the view which sees in Byzantine literature no satirical tradition. Furthermore the evidence it provides confirms "that the quality of Byzantine secular literature is sometimes a good deal higher than what is usually conceded" (p. 5).

Timarion, a twelfth century satire, survived in a single manuscript, *Codex Vaticanus graecus* 87, which, however, contains much of Lucian's work. Thus traditionally *Timarion* had been classified as pseudo-Lucian. Baldwin bases his translation on Romano's 1974 edition.

Byzantine culture and civilization were never monolithic and at no time was the Byzantine Empire a static and religiously "fundamentalist" state. The established Christian tradition was dominant but not unchallenged, and ancient Greek literature, including mythology, remained debatable issues throughout the Byzantine era. *Timarion* belongs to the type of literature which reveals the "everlasting debate over the fundamentals of Byzantine intellectual life." However, it was not only that "Byzantine authors liked to show off their erudition by stuffing their writings with quotations from and allusions to the Greek classics" (83); rather it was their sense of continuity with the past that made them so attached to ancient Greek literature. They viewed the ancient Greeks as pagans and in error but nevertheless ancestors.

The author of the *Timarion* was one of many who questioned prevailing notions and practices. Nicholas of Methone, one of the leading philosophers-theologians of the same century, complained that there were some intellectuals in Constantinople who exploited opportunities for problems and dissensions in the Church to undermine its authority and to introduce changes and innovations.

Baldwin's translation is lucid and faithful to the meaning of the original. In the introduction he discusses various literary, chronological and historical problems, including the nature of satire and humour as well as the date and authorship of the text. The commentary is rich and illuminating.

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